

MODULE 4: Financial Stewardship and Generosity

At 400 level, this topic should move beyond “giving money” into a **theology of ownership, responsibility, and kingdom impact**. Students should understand that finances are **spiritual, ethical, and missional tools**.

A. Defining Financial Stewardship

Financial stewardship is:

The faithful management of resources entrusted by God for His purposes.

Core Principle:

We are **stewards, not owners**.

Key Scripture:

“The earth is the Lord’s, and everything in it...”

— Psalms 24:1

“It is required that those who have been given a trust must prove faithful.”

— 1 Corinthians 4:2

Teaching Insight:

Ownership mindset → “It’s mine”

Stewardship mindset → “It’s entrusted to me”

B. The Spiritual Nature of Money

Money is not neutral in Scripture—it reveals **heart alignment**.

Key Scripture:

“Where your treasure is, there your heart will be also.”

— Matthew 6:21

“You cannot serve both God and money.”

— Matthew 6:24

Insight:

- Money is a **test of loyalty**
- It exposes priorities and values

C. Biblical Principles of Stewardship

1. Faithfulness in Little

“Whoever is faithful in little is faithful also in much...”

— Luke 16:10

- Stewardship begins at current level—not future wealth

2. Accountability to God

“Each of us will give an account of ourselves to God.”

— Romans 14:12

- Financial decisions are spiritually accountable

3. Wisdom and Planning

“The plans of the diligent lead surely to abundance...”

— Proverbs 21:5

- Budgeting and planning are spiritual disciplines

4. Contentment

“Godliness with contentment is great gain.”

— 1 Timothy 6:6

- Protects against greed and comparison

D. Generosity: The Expression of Stewardship

Stewardship manages resources; **generosity releases them.**

1. Giving Reflects God's Nature

“For God so loved the world that He gave...”

— John 3:16

- Generosity is **God-like behavior**

2. Cheerful Giving

“God loves a cheerful giver.”

— 2 Corinthians 9:7

- Attitude matters more than amount

3. Sacrificial Giving

Example:

- Widow of Zarephath (1 Kings 17)
- Widow's offering (Mark 12:41–44)

Insight:

True generosity is measured by **cost, not quantity**

4. Giving as Investment

“Give, and it will be given to you...”

— Luke 6:38

- Kingdom giving has **spiritual returns**, not transactional profit

E. Tithing and Offerings (Advanced Discussion)

1. Tithing Principle

“Bring the whole tithe into the storehouse...”

— Malachi 3:10

- 10% as a baseline model in the Old Testament

2. New Testament Perspective

- Emphasis shifts to:
 - Willingness
 - Proportion
 - Sacrifice

“Each of you should give what you have decided in your heart...”

— 2 Corinthians 9:7

Teaching Balance:

- Avoid legalism (forced giving)
- Avoid neglect (self-centered living)

F. Dangers in Financial Life

1. Love of Money

“The love of money is a root of all kinds of evil...”

— 1 Timothy 6:10

- Not money itself, but misplaced affection

2. Greed and Materialism

“Watch out! Be on your guard against all kinds of greed...”

— Luke 12:15

3. Debt and Poor Management

“The borrower is slave to the lender.”

— Proverbs 22:7

4. Neglect of the Poor

“Whoever is kind to the poor lends to the Lord...”

— Proverbs 19:17

G. Financial Stewardship and the Total Man

Tie back to earlier topics:

- **Spirit** → surrendered to God (lordship over finances)
- **Soul** → disciplined thinking (planning, contentment)
- **Body** → practical actions (earning, giving, spending)

H. Practical Framework for Students

1. Earn Responsibly

- Honest work
- Ethical practices

“The one who is unwilling to work shall not eat.”

— 2 Thessalonians 3:10

2. Spend Wisely

- Needs vs wants
- Avoid impulsive living

3. Save Intentionally

“Go to the ant... it stores its provisions...”

— Proverbs 6:6–8

4. Give Generously

- To God’s work
- To people in need

I. Reflection Questions (400 Level Depth)

- Do my financial decisions reflect my theology?
- What controls me—God or money?
- Am I a channel or a container?
- Who benefits from my resources?